# Decidable Type-Checking for the Dependent Categorical Combinators

Lexi Aiello[1] and Eric Klavins[2]

[1]Department of Philosophy, University of Washington
[2]Electrical & Computer Engineering Department, University of Washington

April 28, 2026

**Abstract**

We present an extension of the categorical combinators [4] to symmetric monoidal categories, enabling affine dependent typing of the categorical, non-linear combinators. We formalize the metatheory in the Lean 4 proof assistant. We prove several important properties of the calculus, including that type-checking is decidable, and that the affine restriction of the combinators is strongly-normalizing, and globally confluent. We achieve judgmental decidability in principle by showing that the types of all objects can be expressed using the affine restriction, which we demonstrate is strongly-normalizing by a syntactic decreasing measure. We outline key challenges and architectural strategies for formalizing a dependent combinator calculus with such properties in a proof assistant, and describe our progress towards compiling a $\lambda$-calculus with dependent types ($\Pi$-types and $\Sigma$-types) to our combinators.

## 1 Introduction

Simply-typed combinatory logics like the $SK$-combinators are known to be equivalent to the simply-typed $\lambda$-calculus [1]. These calculi can avoid contexts, and might enjoy benefits as such (e.g., unification). Work has been done on extending these logics with dependent types [2], but no implementation has been proposed, nor have such theories been formalized in a proof assistant.

Combinatory logics suffer from the known disadvantage that they are an inefficient compilation target. For example, when compiling the $\lambda$-calculus to the $SK$-combinators, terms explode in size due to lacking variable substitution [7, p. 267].

Numerous alternative combinatory compilation targets have been proposed. One such calculus is the categorical combinator calculus [4]. The categorical combinators are best described as a literal interpretation of cartesian closed categories as a Lisp-like Debruijn-indexed machine (the Categorical Abstract Machine [3]). Variable substitution is modeled intuitively as composing binary product projections [3, p. 6] over an environment of nested tuples. The categorical combinators have been extended with simple types [4]. There has also been some investigation into extending them to a dependent type theory similar to the Calculus of Constructions [8], but no implementation has been defined.

In this paper, we formalize a metatheory of a dependently-typed categorical combinator calculus with affine types and non-linear terms based on symmetric monoidal categories. We show that type inference is decidable and deterministic. We accomplish this goal in principle by observing that the types of the dependent non-linear categorical combinators are encodable with an affine subset of the usual reduction rules. By showing that the affine restriction of the calculus is strongly normalizing through a syntactic decreasing measure, we achieve total affine $\beta$-reduction. We show that the calculus satisfies global confluence by Newman's lemma [6] using our measure. We prove completeness and soundness of affine $\beta$-reduction, and soundness of $\beta$-normal forms with respect to our reduction relation, and hence achieve decidable affine equality. We are able to avoid a conversion rule in the typing judgment by eagerly normalizing types, and thus achieve deterministic, decidable type inference. We do not assume $\Pi$-extensionality, but describe $\eta$-reduction rules used for a weak form of extensionality as in Curien et al. [4, p. 221]. We outline several of our architectural decisions including proof automation with typeclasses critical to satisfying our formalization goals in Lean 4.

# 2 Background

## 2.1 The Untyped Categorical Combinators

The categorical combinators [4] are the basis of the Categorical Abstract Machine [3]. They are a potential compilation target for the $\lambda$-calculus [3]. Categorical combinators simulate variable substitution through projections over nested tuples ("couples", or binary products) constituting an "environment". Binders are simulated through a curry combinator ($\Lambda$) which applies its two arguments as a couple to the body ($\Lambda(x)$). The reduction rules for the calculus resemble the rules of the SK combinator calculus, and their categorical semantics are given by cartesian-closed categories [3, p. 178].

| | |
|---|---|
| (ass) | $(x \circ y)z = x(yz)$ |
| (fst) | $Fst(a, b) = a$ |
| (snd) | $Snd(a, b) = b$ |
| (dpair) | $\langle x, y\rangle z = (xz, yz)$ |
| (curr) | $\Lambda(x)yz = x(y, z)$ |
| (app) | $App(f, x) = fx$ |
| (quote) | $`(x)y = x$ |

Figure 1: Reduction rules of the untyped combinators as seen in the Categorical Abstract Machine.

## 2.2 The Simply-Typed Categorical Combinators

Curien extends the combinators with type annotations [4, p. 220], enabling simple typing. Quotation is omitted in the simply-typed variant. The inference rules are as such:

$$\textsc{Id}\ \frac{\alpha : \text{Type}}{Id(\alpha) : \alpha \to \alpha} \qquad \textsc{Coup}\ \frac{x : \alpha, y : \beta}{(x, y) : \alpha \times \beta} \qquad \textsc{Comp}\ \frac{x : \beta \to \gamma, y : \alpha \to \beta}{(x \circ y) : \alpha \to \gamma}$$

$$\textsc{Fst}\ \frac{\alpha : \text{Type}, \beta : \text{Type}}{Fst(\alpha, \beta) : \alpha \times \beta \to \alpha} \qquad \textsc{Snd}\ \frac{\alpha : \text{Type}, \beta : \text{Type}}{Snd(\alpha, \beta) : \alpha \times \beta \to \beta} \qquad \textsc{Pair}\ \frac{x : \alpha \to \tau_1, y : \alpha \to \tau_2}{\langle x, y\rangle : \alpha \to \tau_1 \times \tau_2}$$

$$\textsc{Curr}\ \frac{x : (\alpha \times \beta) \to \tau}{\Lambda(x) : \alpha \to \beta \to \tau} \qquad \textsc{Appl}\ \frac{\alpha : \text{Type}, \beta : \text{Type}}{App(\alpha, \beta) : ((\alpha \to \beta) \times \alpha) \to \beta} \qquad \textsc{App}\ \frac{f : \alpha \to \beta \qquad x : \alpha}{fx : \beta}$$

Figure 2: Inference rules of the simply-typed categorical combinators

Curien's categorical combinators are nominally combinatory, but differ from $SK$ and $BCKI$ calculi in that points are still present. In its simply-typed form [4, p. 220], the calculus has not one primitive combinator without a point, and no object (besides application) has an arity of more than one [3, p. 177]. Type arguments are given as points, projection mappings in pairs are given as points ($\langle f, g\rangle$), the Curry combinator is defined by a point ($\Lambda(x)$), couple members are specified as points ($(a, b)$), and composition is pointed with respect to $f$ and $g$ ($(f \circ g)x$). This superficially obscure design decision is quite natural when interpreting projection over couples ($((x_1, x_2), \ldots x_n)$) as debruijn argument indexing. Take an example reduction in the untyped calculus:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\Lambda(\Lambda(App \circ \langle Snd \circ Fst, App \circ \langle App \circ Fst, Snd\rangle\rangle))nfx \\
&= \Lambda(App \circ \langle Snd \circ Fst, App \circ \langle App \circ Fst, Snd\rangle\rangle)(n, f)x \\
&= (App \circ \langle Snd \circ Fst, App \circ \langle App \circ Fst, Snd\rangle\rangle)((n, f), x) \\
&= App(f, App(App(n, f), x)) \\
&= f(nfx)
\end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Despite every visible operation being bound by a point, arguments in scope can be rearranged through projections, composition, pairing, and the application combinator which corresponds to evaluation in the cartesian closed category.

# 3 Dependent Categorical Combinators

Our primary insight when extending the categorical combinators to dependent types is that the types of all of the categorical combinators are representable without making use of the pair rule. That is, their types are affine. We refer to the subset of the categorical combinators excluding the pair rule as the "affine restriction." By showing that the affine restriction is strongly normalizing, we gain decidable judgmental equality ($\equiv$) and a decision procedure for type-checking.

Second, we interpret $\Sigma$-types as a telescope-encoded context as usual, but also view the pair rule ($\langle f, g\rangle x = (fx, gx)$) as a substitution or morphism between contexts.

Finally, as in the curry combinator, we specify combinator type arguments as term points that internalize an indexing of the environment (as in Tarski universes). For example, the $\Pi$ combinator is inferred like such:

$$\frac{\delta : \text{Sort } m, f_\alpha : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n, f_\beta : \Pi_{s:\delta, x:f_\alpha(s)}, \text{Sort } o}{\Pi(f_\alpha, f_\beta) : \delta \to \text{Sort } o}\ \text{PI} \tag{2}$$

We similarly regard couples as meaningful traversable data, but reinterpret them as $\Sigma$-pairs. $\Sigma$-couples make traversing data in a well-typed way quite convenient, and can naturally encode typing judgments. This approach also allows $\Pi$ universe levels to be computed by our core inference rules without any modification. We similarly define most of the type arguments of the combinators through Tarski universe. By specifying type arguments in this way, some potential duplication of items in the context can be avoided, thus further enabling a purely affine type theory.

## 3.1 Couples as Degenerate Dependent Sums

Recall the typical typing of a $\Sigma$-pair:

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash \alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{\Gamma \vdash \Sigma(\alpha, \beta) : \text{Sort } max(m, n)} \tag{3}$$

A $\Sigma$-type can be placed under a $\lambda$-binder, referencing bound variables in its $fst$ and $snd$ types, and $fst$ itself in the type of $snd$. $\Sigma$-types are one of the canonical dependent types, alongside dependent products. There is a known equivalence between $\Pi$ and $\Sigma$ [5, p. 50], in that a function $\Pi_{x:\alpha, y:\beta(x)}, \gamma xy$ can be transofmred into a dependent function $\Pi_{s:\Sigma(\alpha,\beta)}, \gamma(s.fst, s.snd)$, and vice-versa ("currying"-"uncurrying").

In the untyped categorical combinators, Curry-Uncurry can be written as:

$$\begin{aligned} Curry(x) &:= \Lambda(x) \\ Uncurry(x) &:= App \circ \langle x \circ Fst, Snd\rangle \\ Uncurry(x)(y, z) &= xyz \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

In a dependently-typed categorical combinator calculus where couples are naively interpreted as $\Sigma$ pairs with point-free type arguments, this (4) derivation becomes prohibitively difficult, especially in an affine setting. In $Uncurry(x)$, $snd\ (z : \beta y)$ depends on the $fst$ component $(y : \alpha)$ of the encapsulating couple's preimage, despite $y$ being destroyed upon reducing the pair application. $App$ has no knowledge of $y$, and cannot calculate the type of $(xy, z)$. We avoid this contention by interpreting the type of $\Sigma$ through type points indexing the environment (5), similarly to the term $x$ in Curry ($\Lambda(x)$).

We formally interpret couples $[\![\beta]\!](a, b)$ as a degenerate case of $\Sigma$, where the environment conveys no extra meaningful information, and $\beta$ depends only on $fst$. We represent a no-op indexing of the environment with a unit type $\top$ so as to avoid universe arguments to $\Sigma$.

This view of couples as sigma terms naturally encodes the notion of judgments. For example, the term $[\![\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m)]\!](\alpha, x)$ corresponds to the judgment $x : \alpha$. Similarly, a context $\Gamma$ can be encoded as a nested couple:

$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, f_\beta : \delta \to \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{\Sigma(f_\beta) : \delta \to \text{Sort } max(m,n)} \text{ SIGMA} \tag{5}$$

Figure 3: Where $\delta$ denotes an arbitrary environment and $\alpha$ denotes the $fst$ component. $\Sigma(f_\beta)(env : \delta) : \text{Sort } max(m,n)$

$$\frac{}{\top : \text{Sort } 0} \text{ TOP} \tag{6}$$

$$\frac{}{* : \top} \text{ UNIT} \tag{7}$$

$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n, x : \alpha, y : (\beta x}{[\![\beta]\!](x,y) : \Sigma(\text{`(Sort } m, \beta))\alpha} \text{ COUP} \tag{8}$$

$$x_0 : A_0, x_1 : A_1(x_0), x_2 : A_2(x_0, x_1) \approx [\![\Sigma(A_0, A_1), A_2]\!]([\![A_0, A_1]\!](x_0, x_1), x_2) \tag{9}$$

In the categorical abstract machine, this encoding of judgments corresponds to an environment where variable assignments are explicitly typed.

## 3.2 Type Annotations as Points via Couple-Judgments

Except for $\Pi$, all combinator objects have type annotations specified as points. For example, the projection $Fst(\alpha, \beta)$ is indexed by terms denoting the type of the expected $\Sigma$-couple. This contradicts intuition that type arguments must be able to depend on other terms, and thus, cannot be points. However, by referring to terms in the context as the $snd$ component of a $\Sigma$-couple ($\Sigma(\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m))$) mentioning its type, they only need to be referred to by their respective sorts. As a result, we avoid another potential duplication of type-points inside the combinators' types. $\Sigma$-judgments are also an example of "very dependent" types, as defined by Altenkirch et al. [2].

See (3.3.11) where we derive point-free $Id\ \alpha$ using the dependent curry ($\Lambda$) combinator and $\Sigma$-judgments.

## 3.3 Inference Rules

We make use of an infinite sort hierarchy to avoid paradoxes (i.e., Sort $m$ : Sort $m+1$). We also use the notation $\Pi(x : A), B$, and may omit type arguments for legibility to denote an illustration of a type. However, the full combinatory, point-free types are accessible in the appendix. We use $A \to B$ as shorthand for our definition of arrows (13), but arrows are not first-class, and are merely an application of $\Pi(m,n)$.

### 3.3.1 Application and $\Pi$

The inference rule for function application is as usual, except the codomain $\beta$ is applied the $\Sigma$-judgment $[\![\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m)]\!](\alpha, x)$.

$$\frac{f : \Pi(m,n)\alpha\beta \qquad x : \alpha}{fx : \beta[\![\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m)]\!](\alpha, x)} \text{ APP} \tag{10}$$

Figure 4: Inference rule: application

Since we do not make use of variables, $\Pi(m,n)$ is itself a dependent combinator, naively dependently typed (11). However, since we apply function type codomains ($\beta$) with $[\![\ldots]\!](\alpha, x)$, it can be expressed as an arrow type (12). Our use of the judgment-couple convention in the type of $\Pi(m,n)$ proves to be useful in several other combinator types, avoiding duplication of elements in the context.

### 3.3.2 Arrow types

We define nondependent arrows ($\alpha \to \beta$) as such (where '(...) denotes the quotation combinator of arity 3):

$$\Pi(m,n) : \Pi(\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n), \text{Sort } n \tag{11}$$

Figure 5: Naive typing of $\Pi(m,n)$ with a dependent type

$$\frac{}{\Pi(m,n) : \text{Sort } m \to (\Sigma(\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m)) \to \text{Sort } n) \to \text{Sort } n} \tag{12}$$

Figure 6: Arrow typing of $\Pi(m,n)$ using $\Sigma$-judgments

$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m \qquad \beta : \text{Sort } n}{\alpha \to \beta \coloneqq \Pi(m,n)\ \alpha\ \text{`}(\text{Sort } n, \Sigma(\text{Sort } n, Id(\text{Sort } m)), \beta)} \tag{13}$$

#### 3.3.3 Couple Projections

We define dependent and nondependent versions of *Snd* projection to bootstrap several of the combinators' types. $Fst(\alpha,\beta)$ is not dependent, since $\alpha$ does not depend on $\beta$ in $\Sigma(\alpha,\beta)$. We use $\circ'$ to denote nondependent composition where $g : \alpha \to \beta$ and $f : \beta \to \alpha$. The inference rules for projection on couples are as such:

#### 3.3.4 Identity combinator

As do all other combinators, $Id$ accepts $\alpha$ as a point. Its type is a simple arrow:

$$\frac{\textsc{Id} \quad \alpha : \text{Sort } m}{Id(\alpha) : \alpha \to \alpha} \tag{14}$$

#### 3.3.5 Flip combinator

We extend Curien's combinators [4] with a $Flip(x)$ combinator. We do so to avoid copying when applying an argument under $\Pi(m,n)$ as the domain of a subsequent $\Pi(n,o)\beta$ object:

$$\frac{\textsc{Flip} \quad x : \alpha \to \beta \to \gamma}{Flip(x) : \beta \to \alpha \to \gamma} \tag{15}$$

#### 3.3.6 Dependent and nondependent composition

We have nondependent composition as in Curien's combinators, and add a dependent version. Naively interpreting composition as dependent leads to the $S$ combinator, so we use our $\Sigma$-couples to avoid duplication and preserve dependency.

$$\frac{\textsc{Naive comp.} \quad f : \Pi(x : \alpha), \beta(x), g : \Pi(x : ?), \gamma(fx)}{(g \circ f) : \Pi(x : \alpha), \gamma(fx)} \tag{16}$$

Note that the codomain of $f$ depends on $x : \alpha$, but the domain of $g$ also depends on $fx : \beta(x)$. By duplicating $x$, ? can be determined:

We avoid copying $x$ altogether by stipulating that $f$ produce a couple $\Sigma(\alpha,\beta)$. As such, duplication is handed off to term-level $\beta$-reduction, and our types remain affine. We define composition point-free, up to the type arguments $\alpha, \beta, \gamma$ (18). The type of the nondependent composition operator is the same as in Curien's simply-typed combinators [4, p. 220] (19).

#### 3.3.7 Pairs

Recall $\langle f, g\rangle x = (fx, gx)$. We extend the pair operator with type arguments $\beta$, $\gamma$, which dictate the types of the resulting $fst$, and *snd* component, respectively. All arguments, up to $x$, are given by points (20).

FST
$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{Fst(\alpha, \beta) : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta) \to \alpha}$$

SND'
$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{Snd'(\alpha, \beta) : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta) \to \beta}$$

SND
$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{Snd(\alpha, \beta) : \Pi(s : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta)), \beta(Snd\ s)}$$

NAIVE COMP.
$$\frac{f : \Pi(x : \alpha), \beta(x), g : \Pi(x : \alpha, y : \beta(x)), \gamma x(fx)}{(g \circ f) : \Pi(x : \alpha), \gamma(fx)} \tag{17}$$

COMP.
$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n, \gamma : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta) \to \text{Sort } o}{[\![\alpha, \beta, \gamma]\!] \circ : \Pi(f : \alpha \to \Sigma(\alpha, \beta), g : \Pi(x : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta)), \gamma(x), x : \alpha), \gamma(fx)} \tag{18}$$

Figure 7: Inference rule: composition in illustrative notation.

NONDEP. COMP.
$$\frac{f : \alpha \to \beta, g : \beta \to \gamma}{(g \circ f) : \alpha \to \gamma} \tag{19}$$

Figure 8: Inference rule: nondependent composition

PAIR
$$\frac{\beta : \text{Sort } n, \gamma : \beta \to \text{Sort } o, f : \alpha \to \beta, g : \Pi(x : \alpha), \gamma(fx)}{[\![\beta, \gamma]\!]\langle f, g\rangle : \alpha \to \Sigma(\beta, \gamma)} \tag{20}$$

### 3.3.8 Quotation

The quotation operator ($`(\alpha, \beta, x)$) is not dependent, but a dependent version like the dependent $K$ combinator can be derived as in our $Id(m)$ derivation (3.3.11).

### 3.3.9 Tail and head-dependent Curry

Recall $\Lambda(x)yz = x(y, z)$. Since $x$ is applied a $\Sigma$-couple, $z$ must depend on $y$. That is, $z : \beta(y)$. However, $x$ also depends on the couple $[\![\alpha, \beta]\!](y, z)$. To keep usages of $y$ and $z$ affine, we define two versions of $\Lambda(x)$. The former, $\Lambda'(\alpha, \beta, x)$ is "head-dependent", in that $z$ may depend on $y$, but $x$ has a fixed codomain (22). The latter, $\Lambda(\alpha, x)$ is "tail-dependent", in that $y$ is itself a sort, z is an inhabitant of $y$, and $x$ depends on $[\![\alpha, Id(\alpha)]\!](y, z)$ (23).

### 3.3.10 App combinator

As in Curien's combinators, the *App* combinator evaluates a couple as a computation. We extend *App* with type arguments ($App(n, \alpha, \beta)$) and give it the obvious dependent type (24).

APPL
$$\frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n}{App(n, \alpha, \beta) : \Pi(x : \Sigma(\Pi(x : \alpha), \beta(x), \alpha)), \beta(Snd\ x)} \tag{24}$$

Figure 11: Inference rule for *App* written illustratively.

$$\textsc{Quot}\quad \frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \text{Sort } n, x : \alpha}{`(\alpha, \beta, x) : \beta \to \alpha} \tag{21}$$

$$\textsc{Head Curry}\quad \frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m, \beta : \alpha \to \text{Sort } n, x : \Sigma(\alpha, \beta) \to \gamma}{\Lambda'(\alpha, \beta, x) : \Pi(x : \alpha, y : \beta(x)), \gamma} \tag{22}$$

Figure 9: Inference rule: head-dependent curry

$$\textsc{Tail Curry}\quad \frac{\alpha : \text{Sort } m + 1, x : \Pi(s : \Sigma(\alpha, Id(\alpha))), \gamma(s)}{\Lambda(\alpha, x) : \Pi(x : \alpha, y : x), \gamma[\![\alpha, Id(\alpha)]\!](x, y)} \tag{23}$$

Figure 10: Inference rule: tail-dependent curry

#### 3.3.11 Derivation: Point-Free $Id$

Recall the types of $Id$, $\Lambda(\alpha, x)$, and $Snd(\alpha, \beta)$ as above. Note that the projection $Snd(\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m))$ is well-typed, even if $\alpha$ in $Id(m)$ $\alpha$ is not known. So, let $Id_m$ be as follows:

$$Id_m \coloneqq \Lambda(\text{Sort } m, Snd(\text{Sort } m, Id(\text{Sort } m)))$$

See the appendix for a mechanized proof that $Id_m(\alpha : \text{Sort } m)(x : \alpha)$ type-checks.

# 4 Reduction & Affine Reduction

Our reduction rules are the same as in the categorical abstract machine [3], except for *Flip*, and pairs, which carry type arguments:

| | |
|---|---|
| (id) | $Id(\alpha)x \to x$ |
| (ass') | $(x \circ' y)z \to x(yz)$ |
| (ass) | $[\![\alpha, \beta, \gamma]\!] \circ xyz \to x(yz)$ |
| (fst) | $Fst(\alpha, \beta)\ [\![\ldots]\!](a, b) \to a$ |
| (snd) | $Snd(\alpha, \beta)\ [\![\ldots]\!](a, b) \to b$ |
| (snd') | $Snd(\alpha, \beta)\ [\![\ldots]\!](a, b) \to b$ |
| (curr') | $\Lambda'(\alpha, \beta, x)yz \to x\ [\![\alpha, \beta]\!](y, z)$ |
| (curr) | $\Lambda(\alpha, x)yz \to x\ [\![\alpha, Id(\alpha)]\!](y, z)$ |
| (app) | $App(n, \alpha, \beta)\ [\![\ldots]\!](f, x) \to fx$ |
| (quote) | $`(\alpha, \beta, x)y \to x$ |
| (flip) | $Flip(x)yz \to xzy$ |
| (dpair) | $[\![\alpha, \beta]\!]\langle x, y\rangle\ z \to [\![\alpha, \beta]\!](xz, yz)$ |

$$\text{(congr. fun.)}\quad \frac{f \to f'}{fx \to f'x} \qquad \text{(congr. arg.)}\quad \frac{x \to x'}{fx \to fx'}$$

Figure 12: Reduction rules of the dependently-typed categorical combinators

## 4.1 Affine Strong Normalization

Note that, excluding our *dpair* rule, each single-step combinator reduction uses each of its arguments at most once. That is, this restriction of single-step reduction is affine. Except for congruence, each rule

```
inductive Size : Expr → ℕ → Prop
  | sig    : Size (DCC Σ(_m, _n)) 0
  | coup   : Size (DCC ⟦α, β⟧(,)) 0
  | pi     : Size (DCC Π(_m, _n)) 0
  | sort   : Size (DCC Sort m) 0
  | id     : Size (DCC Id(α)) 1
  | comp   : Size (DCC ⟦α, β, γ⟧∘) 1
  | fst    : Size (DCC Fst(α, β)) 1
  | snd    : Size (DCC Snd(α, β)) 1
  | snd'   : Size (DCC Snd'(α, β)) 1
  | appl   : Size (DCC App(_n, α, β)) 1
  | flip   : Size e m → Size (DCC Flip(e)) m.succ
  | quot   : Size x m → Size (DCC `(α, β, x)) m.succ
  | comp'  : Size f m → Size g n → Size (DCC (f ∘' g)) (m + n).succ
  | pair   : Size f m → Size g n → Size (DCC ⟦α, β⟧⟨f, g⟩) (m + n).succ
  | curr   : Size x m → Size (DCC Λ(α, x)) m.succ
  | curr'  : Size x m → Size (DCC Λ'(α, β, x)) m.succ
  | app    : Size f m → Size x n → Size (DCC (f x)) (m + n)
```

Figure 13: Syntactic size measure for the combinators

decreases the number of combinators (we do not consider the couple $[\![\alpha, \beta]\!](,)$ to be a combinator). We thus define a syntactic measure of term size on objects in our calculus, and show that it decreases under affine reduction ($\dashrightarrow$) to show that the affine reduction is strongly normalizing.

Formally, we define affine reduction ($\dashrightarrow$) as such:

```
inductive RedAff : Expr → Expr → Prop
  | app      : RedAff (DCC (App(_n, _δ, _τ) ⟦α, β⟧(f, x))) (DCC (f x))
  | fst      : RedAff (DCC (Fst(_δ, _τ) ⟦α, β⟧(a, b))) a
  | snd      : RedAff (DCC (Snd(_δ, _τ) ⟦α, β⟧(a, b))) b
  | snd'     : RedAff (DCC (Snd'(_δ, _τ) ⟦α, β⟧(a, b))) b
  | flip     : RedAff (DCC (Flip(e) x y)) (DCC (e y x))
  | id       : RedAff (DCC (Id(_α) x)) x
  | quot     : RedAff (DCC (`(_α, _β, x) y)) x
  | comp     : RedAff (DCC ((⟦α, β, γ⟧∘ x y) z)) (DCC (x (y z)))
  | comp'    : RedAff (DCC ((x ∘' y) z)) (DCC (x (y z)))
  | curr     : RedAff (DCC (Λ(α, x) y z)) (DCC (x ⟦α, Id(α)⟧(y, z)))
  | curr'    : RedAff (DCC (Λ'(α, β, x) y z)) (DCC (x ⟦α, β⟧(y, z)))
  | congrFun : RedAff f f' → RedAff (DCC (f x)) (DCC (f' x))
  | congrArg : RedAff x x' → RedAff (DCC (f x)) (DCC (f x'))
```

We define the size of all reducible combinators to be the successor of the sum of the sizes of the combinators' constituent term points. For example, $Id(\alpha)$ has size 1, since its point is a term-type, not a term with computational relevance. Irreducible terms are assigned a size of 0 (13). We also define a computable `size (e : Expr) : ((n : ℕ) × (PLift (Size e n)))` function which produces a proof of `Size e n`, thus gaining soundness by default (definition omitted, see appendix).

**Theorem 1.** *If $A \in Expr$ and $A \dashrightarrow B$, then $size(B) < size(A)$.*

*Proof.*

```
theorem RedAff.decreasing (h : RedAff e e') : (size e').fst < (size e).fst := by
  induction h <;> (simp [size]; try grind)
```

□

We define strong normalization using Lean's accessibility predicate, and use our decreasing measure to produce a proof of `Acc (fun b a => RedAff a b) e`.

**Theorem 2.** *If $A \in Expr$, then $A$ is strongly-normalizing under affine reduction ($\dashrightarrow$).*

*Proof.*

```
def sn (e : Expr) : Acc (fun b a => RedAff a b) e := Acc.intro e (fun e' hr => by
  have h := hr.decreasing
  exact e'.sn)
termination_by e.size.fst

instance instWellFounded : WellFounded (fun a b => RedAff b a) := ⟨sn⟩
```

□

## 4.2 Affine Global Confluence

We define the transitive ($\dashrightarrow^+$) and reflexive transitive closure ($\dashrightarrow^*$) like such:

```
def RedAffTrans     := Relation.TransGen RedAff
def RedAffReflTrans := Relation.ReflTransGen RedAff
```

**Theorem 3.** *For all $A \in Expr$, $A$ is confluent under $\dashrightarrow$.*

*Proof.* We proceed by induction and case analysis on $\dashrightarrow$. Cases have been omitted for brevity. Consult the appendix.

```
theorem RedAff.conf (h₁ : RedAff A B) (h₂ : RedAff A C) :
  ∃ D, RedAffReflTrans B D ∧ RedAffReflTrans C D := by
  induction h₁ generalizing C with
  | comp =>
    cases h₂ with
    | comp => exact ⟨_, .refl, .refl⟩
    | congrFun h =>
      cases h with
      | congrFun h =>
        cases h with
        | congrFun h => cases h
        | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single (.congrFun h), .single .comp⟩
      | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single (.congrArg (.congrFun h)), .single .comp⟩
      | congrArg h =>
        exact ⟨_, .single (.congrArg (.congrArg (by assumption))), .single .comp⟩
  | congrFun h_r ih =>
    cases h₂
    case comp' | quot | id | app | fst | snd | snd' => cases h_r
    case flip =>
      cases h_r with
      | congrFun h => cases h
      | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single .flip, .single (.congrArg h)⟩
    case comp =>
      cases h_r with
      | congrFun h =>
        cases h with
        | congrFun h => cases h
        | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single .comp, .congrFun (.single h)⟩
      | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single .comp, .congrArg (.congrFun (.single h))⟩
    case curr =>
      cases h_r with
      | congrFun h => cases h
      | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single .curr, .single (.congrArg (.sigl (by assumption)))⟩
    case curr' =>
      cases h_r with
      | congrFun h => cases h
      | congrArg h => exact ⟨_, .single .curr', .single (.congrArg (.sigl (by assumption)))⟩
    case congrFun f f' x f'' h =>
      have ⟨_, h₁, h₂⟩ := ih h
      exact ⟨_, .congrFun h₁, .congrFun h₂⟩
    case congrArg f f' x x'' h_x =>
      exact ⟨_, .congrArg (.single h_x), .congrFun (.single h_r)⟩
  | _ =>
    -- remaining cases omitted
    sorry
```

□

**Theorem 4.** *For all $A \in Expr$, $A$ is confluent under $\dashrightarrow^*$.*

*Proof.* We proceed by induction on the well-founded relation $\dashrightarrow$ (4.1).

```
theorem RedAffReflTrans.conf (h₁ : RedAffReflTrans A B) (h₂ : RedAffReflTrans A C) :
  ∃ D, RedAffReflTrans B D ∧ RedAffReflTrans C D := by
  induction A using instWellFounded.induction generalizing B C with
  | h _ ih =>
    match h₁.cases_head, h₂.cases_head with
    | .inr ⟨_, hra, hrc⟩, .inr ⟨_, hra', hrc'⟩ =>
      have ⟨_, c₁', c₂'⟩ := hra.conf hra'
      have ⟨_, hrB, hrB'⟩ := ih _ hra hrc c₁'
      have ⟨_, hrC, hrC'⟩ := ih _ hra' hrc' c₂'
      have ⟨_, h₁, h₂⟩ := ih _ hra (c₁'.trans hrB') (c₁'.trans hrC')
      exact ⟨_, .trans hrB h₁, .trans hrC h₂⟩
```

```
  | .inl heq₁, .inl heq₂ =>
    rw [← heq₁, ← heq₂]
    exact ⟨_, .refl, .refl⟩
  | .inl heq₁, .inr _ =>
    rw [← heq₁]
    exact ⟨_, h₂, .refl⟩
  | .inr _, .inl heq₁ =>
    rw [← heq₁]
    exact ⟨_, .refl, h₁⟩
```

□

**Theorem 5.** *For all $A \in Expr$, if $A \dashrightarrow B$ and $A \dashrightarrow C$, and $B$ and $C$ are normal forms, then $B = C$.*

*Proof.* We define normal forms as such:

```
def IsNormAff (e : Expr) : Prop := ¬ ∃ e', RedAff e e'
```

We proceed by induction on the common reduct of $B$ and $C$:

```
theorem RedAff.norm_unique (h₁ : RedAff A B) (h_norm : B.IsNormAff)
  (h₂ : RedAff A C) (h_norm₂ : C.IsNormAff) : B = C := by
  have ⟨D, ha, hb⟩ := h₁.conf h₂
  match ha.cases_head, hb.cases_head with
  | .inl h₁, .inl h₂ =>
    simp_all
  | .inr ⟨c₁, h₁, h₂⟩, _ =>
    exact h_norm.elim ⟨_, h₁⟩
  | _, .inr ⟨c₁, h₁, h₂⟩ =>
    exact h_norm₂.elim ⟨_, h₁⟩
```

□

**Theorem 6.** *For all $A \in Expr$, if $A \dashrightarrow^* B$ and $A \dashrightarrow^* C$, and $B$ and $C$ are normal forms, then $B = C$.*

*Proof.* We proceed by induction on the common reduct of $B$ and $C$.

```
theorem RedAffReflTrans.norm_unique (h₁ : RedAffReflTrans A B) (h_norm : B.IsNormAff)
  (h₂ : RedAffReflTrans A C) (h_norm₂ : C.IsNormAff) : B = C := by
  have ⟨D, ha, hb⟩ := h₁.conf h₂
  match ha.cases_head, hb.cases_head with
  | .inl h₁, .inl h₂ =>
    simp_all
  | .inr ⟨c₁, h₁, h₂⟩, _ =>
    exact h_norm.elim ⟨_, h₁⟩
  | _, .inr ⟨c₁, h₁, h₂⟩ =>
    exact h_norm₂.elim ⟨_, h₁⟩
```

□

## 4.3 Decidable Beta-Equality

We give a decision procedure for $=_\beta$. We do so by proving soundness and completeness for $\beta$-reduction (with respect to normal-forms). We thus implement an instance of:

```
∃ C, RedAffReflTrans A C ∧ RedAffReflTrans B C ∧ C.IsNormAff
```

First, we define `step` and `reduce` functions with soundness using our measure:

```
def step? (e : Expr) : Option ((e' : Expr) × (PLift (RedAff e e'))) :=
  match e with
  | (DCC (App(_n, _δ, _τ) ⟦_α, _β⟧(f, x)))  => .some ⟨(DCC (f x)), ⟨.app⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Fst(_δ, _τ) ⟦_α, _β⟧(a, _b)))     => .some ⟨a, ⟨.fst⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Snd(_δ, _τ) ⟦_α, _β⟧(_a, b)))     => .some ⟨b, ⟨.snd⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Snd'(_δ, _τ) ⟦_α, _β⟧(_a, b)))    => .some ⟨b, ⟨.snd'⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Flip(e) x y))                     => .some ⟨(DCC (e y x)), ⟨.flip⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Id(_α) x))                        => .some ⟨x, ⟨.id⟩⟩
  | (DCC (`(_α, _β, x) _y))                 => .some ⟨x, ⟨.quot⟩⟩
  | (DCC ((⟦_α, _β, _y⟧∘ x y) z))           => .some ⟨(DCC (x (y z))), ⟨.comp⟩⟩
  | (DCC ((x ∘' y) z))                      => .some ⟨(DCC (x (y z))), ⟨.comp'⟩⟩
```

```
  | (DCC (Λ(α, x) y z))                    => .some ⟨(DCC (x ⟦α, Id(α)⟧(y, z))), ⟨.curr⟩⟩
  | (DCC (Λ'(α, β, x) y z))              => .some ⟨(DCC (x ⟦α, β⟧(y, z))), ⟨.curr'⟩⟩
  | DCC (f x) =>
    match f.step?, x.step? with
    | .some ⟨f', ⟨h₁⟩⟩, _ => .some ⟨(DCC (f' x)), ⟨.congrFun h₁⟩⟩
    | _, .some ⟨x', ⟨h₁⟩⟩ => .some ⟨(DCC (f x')), ⟨.congrArg h₁⟩⟩
    | _, _ => .none
  | _ => .none

def reduce (e : Expr) : Expr :=
  match step? e with
  | .some ⟨e', ⟨h⟩⟩ =>
    have _h_size : e'.size.fst < e.size.fst := h.decreasing
    e'.reduce
  | .none => e
```

**Theorem 7.** *For all $A \in Expr$, and* `reduce A = B`*, then* $A \dashrightarrow^* B$.

*Proof.*

```
theorem reduce_sound (heq : reduce A = B) : RedAffReflTrans A B := by
  induction A using instWellFounded.induction generalizing B with
  | h a ih =>
    unfold reduce at heq
    split at heq
    case h_1 h_red h_step_eq =>
      exact Relation.ReflTransGen.trans (.single h_red) (ih _ h_red heq)
    case h_2 => simp_all only [forall_eq']; exact .refl
```

□

By using our decreasing measure and showing completeness for `step?` with respect to normal forms under $\dashrightarrow$, we prove completeness of `reduce` with respect to normal forms under $\dashrightarrow^*$.

**Lemma 1.** *For all $e \in Expr$, if $e$ is a normal form, then* `step? e = none`.

*Proof.*

```
  theorem IsNormAff.complete (h : A.IsNormAff) : (step? A) = .none := by
  apply Option.eq_none_iff_forall_ne_some.mpr
  intro ⟨e', ⟨h₂⟩⟩ heq
  exact (h ⟨_, h₂⟩)
```

□

**Theorem 8.** *For all $A \in Expr$, if $A \dashrightarrow B$ and $B$ is a normal form, then* `step A = some B`.

*Proof.* We proceed by case analysis with respect to the unfolding of `step?`:

```
theorem RedAff.complete (h₁ : RedAff A B) (h_norm : B.IsNormAff) :
  (step? A) = .some ⟨B, ⟨h₁⟩⟩ := by
  unfold step?
  split
  case h_4 | h_3 | h_2 | h_1  =>
    cases heq : h₁
    · rfl
    · rename_i h_r
      have h := h_r.complete h_norm.congrFun
      simp [step?] at h
    · rename_i h_r
      cases h_r
      · rename_i h_r
        cases h_r
        · rename_i h; cases h
        · have h := h_norm.complete
          simp [step?] at h
      · have h := h_norm.complete
        simp [step?] at h
  case h_7 | h_6 =>
    cases heq : h₁
    · rfl
    · rename_i h; cases h
    · have h := h_norm.complete
    simp [step?] at h
  case h_5 | h_8 | h_9 | h_10 | h_11 | h_12 | h_13 =>
    sorry -- omitted for brevity. See appendix.
```

□

**Lemma 2.** *For all $e \in Expr$, if $e$ is a normal form, then* `reduce e = e`.

*Proof.*

```
theorem IsNormAff.complete_reduce (h : A.IsNormAff) : reduce A = A := by
  unfold reduce
  rw [h.complete]
```

□

**Theorem 9.** *For all $A \in Expr$, if $A \dashrightarrow^* B$, and $B$ is a normal form, then* `reduce A = B`.

*Proof.* By well-founded recursion with respect to the decreasing measure `size`:

```
theorem RedAffReflTrans.complete (h₁ : RedAffReflTrans A B) (h_norm : B.IsNormAff) :
  reduce A = B := by
  match h₁.cases_head with
  | .inl h =>
    simp_all
    exact h_norm.complete_reduce
  | .inr ⟨c, h₁, h₂⟩ =>
    have _h : sizeOf c < sizeOf A := h₁.decreasing
    have h := RedAffReflTrans.complete h₂ h_norm
    rw [h₁.reduce_same, h]
termination_by A.size.fst
```

□

Finally, we show $=_\beta$ is decidable.

**Theorem 10.** *For all $A \in Expr$ and $B \in Expr$, $(\exists C, A \dashrightarrow^* C \wedge B \dashrightarrow^* C \wedge IsNorm(C)) \vee \neg(\exists C, A \dashrightarrow^* C \wedge B \dashrightarrow^* C \wedge IsNorm(C))$.*

*Proof.* This follows from completeness and soundness of `reduce`:

```
instance : Decidable (∃ C, RedAffReflTrans A C ∧ RedAffReflTrans B C ∧ C.IsNormAff) :=
  if heq : reduce A = reduce B then .isTrue
    ⟨_, reduce_sound rfl, reduce_sound heq.symm, reduce_norm rfl⟩
  else
    .isFalse (fun ⟨C, h₁, h₂, h_norm⟩ => by
      have ha := h₁.complete h_norm
      have hb := h₂.complete h_norm
      simp_all)
```

□

# 5 Type Inference

Note that the types of all of the dependent categorical combinators are affine (3.3). Hence, we use our decision procedure (4.3) for $=_\beta$ under affine-reduction to prove decidability of type-checking.

We do not normalize inside our judgment relation, nor do we have a conversion case. We bake conversion into each applicable constructor with a `Reduces` predicate by normalizing the expected and actual types a la carte:

```
inductive Reduces : Expr → Expr → Type
  | mk : RedAffReflTrans A B → IsNormAff B → Reduces A B
deriving Repr

theorem Reduces.complete : Reduces A B → reduce A = B :=
  fun ⟨ha, hb⟩ => ha.complete hb

def reduce_reduces (h : reduce A = B) : Reduces A B := ⟨reduce_sound h, reduce_norm h⟩

def reduce_reduces' : Reduces A A.reduce := reduce_reduces rfl
```

For example, application is inferred like such:

```
inductive Judge : Expr → Expr → Type where
  | app   : Judge f t_f
    → Reduces t_f (DCC (Π(m, n) α β))
    → Judge x t_x
    → Reduces t_x α
    → Judge (DCC (f x)) (DCC (β ⟦Sort m, Id(Sort m)⟧(α, x)))
```

We defer full type normalization to a supplementary predicate, `JudgeConv`:

```
inductive JudgeConv : Expr → Expr → Type
  | mk : Judge x A → Reduces A B → JudgeConv x B
```

We define an `IsArrow` predicate for convenience in pattern matching arrows, which are by convention, Π-objects containing quotation in their codomain. We do not assume Π-extensionality.

```
inductive IsArrow : Expr → (α β : Expr) → Level → Level → Type
  | mk    : Reduces A (arrow α β m n) → IsArrow A α β m n
deriving Repr

def is_arrow (t : Expr) : Option ((α β : Expr) × (m n : Level) × IsArrow t α β m n) :=
  match heq₀ : t.reduce with
  | DCC (Π(m, n) α `(Sort n₂, Σ(Sort m₂, Id(Sort m₃)), β)) =>
    if heq : m = m₂ ∧ m = m₃ ∧ n = n₂ then by
      have ⟨ha, hb, hc⟩ := heq
      rw [← ha, ← hb, ← hc] at heq₀
      refine .some ⟨α, β, m, n, ?_, ?_⟩
      · exact reduce_sound heq₀
      · exact reduce_norm heq₀
    else .none
  | _ => .none
```

Our `Judge` relation models the inference rules (3.3). We have omitted the individual types and corresponding constructors for brevity, but give the constructor for tail-dependent Curry (23) and App (24) as examples. See the appendix and supplementary materials for the full formalization.

```
def curr.type (α γ : Expr) (m n : Level) : Expr :=
  (DCC (Π(m.succ, n) α ((Flip(Π(m, n)) (γ ∘'
  (Λ'(Sort m.succ, Id(Sort m.succ), Id(Σ(Sort m.succ, Id(Sort m.succ))))
    ⟦Sort m.succ, Id(Sort m.succ)⟧(α, Id(α))))) ∘' Snd'(Sort m.succ, α))))

def app_e.type (α β : Expr) (m n : Level) : Expr :=
  let t_f := DCC (Π(m, n) α β)
  let t_x := DCC `(Sort n, t_f, α)

  DCC (Π(max m n, n)
      Σ(t_f, t_x)
      ((Λ'(Sort m, Id(Sort m), β) α) ∘' (Snd(t_f, t_x) ∘ Snd'(Sort (max m n), Σ(t_f, t_x)))))

inductive Judge : Expr → Expr → Type where
  | curr  : Judge α t_α
    → Reduces t_α (DCC (Sort m.succ))
    → Judge x t_x
    → Reduces t_x (DCC (Π(m.succ, n) Σ(α, Id(α)) γ))
    → Judge (DCC Λ(α, x)) (curr.type α γ m n)
  | app_e : Judge α t_α
    → Reduces t_α (DCC Sort m)
    → Judge (DCC App(n, α, β)) (app_e.type α β m n)
  | app   : Judge f t_f
    → Reduces t_f (DCC (Π(m, n) α β))
    → Judge x t_x
    → Reduces t_x α
    → Judge (DCC (f x)) (DCC (β ⟦Sort m, Id(Sort m)⟧(α, x)))
  | sort  : Judge (DCC Sort m) (DCC Sort m.succ)
deriving Repr
```

## 5.1 Computing Type Inference

Using our terminating affine $\beta$-reduction function and `reduce_reduces`, we define an `infer` function with soundness. We give only the cases described in our `Judge` illustration, though the rest are available in supplementary materials. Pattern matching against our `Judge` constructors is somewhat obtuse, primarily due to our design decision to avoid adding a conversion constructor and reducing the inferred types.

```
def infer (e : Expr) : Option ((t : Expr) × (Judge e t)) :=
  match e with
  | DCC Sort m => .some ⟨DCC Sort m.succ, .sort⟩
  | DCC App(n, α, β) =>
    match α.infer with
    | .some ⟨t_α, h_t_α⟩ =>
      match heq₀ : t_α.reduce with
      | DCC Sort m =>
        .some ⟨_, .app_e h_t_α (reduce_reduces heq₀)⟩
      | _ => .none
    | _ => .none
  | DCC Λ(α, x) =>
    match heq₀ : α.infer, x.infer with
    | .some ⟨t_α, h_t_α⟩, .some ⟨t_x, h_t_x⟩ =>
      match heq₁ : t_α.reduce with
      | DCC Sort m + 1 =>
        match heq₃ : t_x.reduce with
        | (DCC (Π(m₂ + 1, n) Σ(α₁, Id(α₂)) γ₂)) =>
          if heq₂ : m₂ = m ∧ α₁ = α ∧ α = α₂ then
            have ⟨ha, hb, hc⟩ := heq₂
            .some ⟨_, Judge.curr
              h_t_α
              (reduce_reduces heq₁)
              h_t_x
              (ha ▸ hb ▸ hc ▸ (reduce_reduces heq₃))⟩
          else .none
        | _ => .none
      | _ => .none
    | _, _ => .none
  | DCC (f x) => match f.infer, x.infer with
    | .some ⟨t_f, h_f⟩, .some ⟨t_x, h_x⟩ =>
      match heq₀ : t_f.reduce, heq₁ : t_x.reduce with
      | DCC (Π(m, n) α₁ β), α₂ =>
        if heq : α₁ = α₂ then
          .some ⟨(DCC (β ⟦Sort m, Id(Sort m)⟧(α₁, x))),
            .app h_f (reduce_reduces heq₀)
                 h_x (reduce_reduces (heq ▸ heq₁))⟩
        else .none
      | _, _ => .none
    | _, _ => .none
  | _ => sorry -- remaining cases omitted for brevity

def infer_conv (e : Expr) : Option ((t : Expr) × JudgeConv e t) :=
  match infer e with
  | .some ⟨t, h⟩ =>
    .some ⟨t.reduce, ⟨h, reduce_reduces rfl⟩⟩
  | _ => .none
```

Avoiding a conversion constructor proves to be quite advantageous, since neither confluence or induction are necessary, and case analysis suffices to prove useful properties. For example, a proof of preservation of $Id(\alpha)x$ is quite straightforward.

**Theorem 11.** *For all $\alpha \in Expr$ and $x \in Expr$, if $Id(\alpha)\ x : reduce(\alpha)$, then $x : reduce(\alpha)$.*

*Proof.* We proceed by case analysis on the judgment $Id(\alpha)\ x : reduce(\alpha)$.

```
def id_preservation (h : JudgeConv (DCC (Id(α) x)) α.reduce) : (JudgeConv x α.reduce) :=
  match h with
  | ⟨.app (.id _ _) b h_t_x _, h_red⟩ => by
    cases reduce_arrow b.complete
    exact ⟨h_t_x, by assumption⟩
```

□

### 5.1.1 Infer Completeness

Yet another advantage of avoiding a conversion constructor, and of having decidable $\beta_=$ is that completeness is provable. We have omitted all but the `curr`, `app_e`, `sort`, and `app` constructors (see supplementary materials).

**Theorem 12.** *For all $e \in Expr$ and $t \in Expr$, if $e : t$, then `infer e = some t`.*

*Proof.* We proceed by parallel induction on the typing derivation and case analysis on the unfolding of `infer`.

```
theorem Judge.complete (h_t : Judge e t) : infer e = .some ⟨t, h_t⟩ := by
  induction h_t with
  | sort =>
    unfold infer
    rfl
  | curr h_t_a h_red₁ h_t_x h_red₂ ih₁ ih₂ =>
    have ha := h_red₁.complete
    have hb := h_red₂.complete
    unfold infer
    rw [ih₁, ih₂]
    simp
    split
    case h_1 heq =>
      rw [heq] at ha
      cases ha
      split
      case h_1 heq =>
        rw [heq] at hb
        cases hb
        simp
        split
        rfl
      case h_2 h =>
        exact (h _ _ _ _ _ hb).elim
    case h_2 h =>
      exact (h _ ha).elim
  | app_e h_t_a h_red₁ ih =>
    have ha := h_red₁.complete
    unfold infer
    rw [ih]
    simp
    split
    case h_1 heq =>
      rw [heq] at ha
      cases ha
      rfl
    case h_2 h =>
      exact (h _ ha).elim
  | app h_t_f h_red_f h_t_x h_red_x ih₁ ih₂ =>
    have ha := h_red_f.complete
    have hb := h_red_x.complete
    unfold infer
    simp [ih₁, ih₂]
    split
    case h_1 heq =>
      rw [heq] at ha
      cases ha
      cases hb
      simp
      aesop
    case h_2 h =>
      exact (h _ _ _ _ ha).elim
```

□

## 5.2 Judgmental Decidability

Using our proof of completeness and soundness proof produced by `infer`, we demonstrate judgmental decidability.

**Theorem 13.** *For all $e \in Expr$ and $t \in Expr$, $e : t \vee \neg e : t$.*

*Proof.*

```
def Judge.decide : Judge e t ⊕ (Judge e t → PLift False) :=
  if h : (infer e).isSome then
    if heq : ((infer e).get h).fst = t then
      .inl (heq ▸ ((infer e).get h).snd)
    else
      .inr fun hn => by
        have h_comp := hn.complete
```

```
      simp_all
  else .inr fun hn => by simp [hn.complete] at *

def JudgeConv.decide : JudgeConv e t ⊕ (JudgeConv e t → PLift False) :=
  if h : (infer e).isSome then
    if heq : ((infer e).get h).fst.reduce = t then
      .inl ⟨((infer e).get h).snd, reduce_reduces heq⟩
    else .inr fun ⟨ha, hb⟩ => by
      have h := ha.complete
      simp_all
      exact (heq hb.complete).elim
  else .inr fun ⟨ha, hb⟩ => by simp [ha.complete] at *
```

□

# 6 Future Work

We hope to use our inference and reduction machinery to mechanize a proof of strong normalization of the entire calculus in the future. That is, a proof of strong normalization for the calculus including the pair combinator, which is not affine.

# 7 Conclusions

Our formalization gives a novel extension of the simply-typed categorical combinators [4, p. 220] to a dependently-typed setting. By mechanizing the theory in Lean 4, we provide several indispensable guarantees about the logic. Most importantly, we demonstrate a mechanism for deciding type inference of the calculus. We demonstrate strong normalization of an affine restriction on the categorical combinators, and use this property to prove soundness and completeness of an inference function with respect to typing judgments. In doing so, we also demonstrate a useful technique to avoid conversion in the typing relation, given we have decidable $\beta_{\to *}$.

Our proof of judgmental decidability is made possible in principle by the observation that the types of the dependent categorical combinators are purely affine. This fact is not true of equivalent systems, like the dependent $SK$ combinators.

Finally, since the categorical combinators are well-known to be a performant compilation target, we believe that our verified implementation could have ramifications towards the efficient execution of dependent type inference in a purely contextless way.


# Acknowledgements

To Jake, for teaching me lambda-calculus.


# A Supplementary Materials

**Lean 4 formalization repository:** https://github.com/lexzaiello/dcc
**Omitted inference cases:** https://github.com/lexzaiello/DCC/blob/master/Dcc/CC/Judge.lean
**Omitted reduction cases:** https://github.com/lexzaiello/DCC/blob/master/Dcc/CC/Step2.lean

# B The Todo List

- Inference rules I am not happy enough with:
  –

# References


[1] Thorsten Altenkirch et al. “Combinatory Logic and Lambda Calculus Are Equal, Algebraically”. In: *International Conference on Formal Structures for Computation and Deduction*. 2023. URL: https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:259298739.

[2] Thorsten Altenkirch et al. “The Münchhausen Method in Type Theory”. In: *28th International Conference on Types for Proofs and Programs (TYPES 2022)*. Ed. by Delia Kesner and Pierre-Marie Pédrot. Vol. 269. Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics (LIPIcs). Dagstuhl, Germany: Schloss Dagstuhl – Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, 2023, 10:1–10:20. ISBN: 978-3-95977-285-3. DOI: 10.4230/LIPIcs.TYPES.2022.10. URL: https://drops.dagstuhl.de/entities/document/10.4230/LIPIcs.TYPES.2022.10.

[3] G. Cousineau, P-L. Curien, and M. Mauny. “The categorical abstract machine”. In: *Functional Programming Languages and Computer Architecture*. Ed. by Jean-Pierre Jouannaud. Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg, 1985, pp. 50–64. ISBN: 978-3-540-39677-2.

[4] P.-L. Curien. “Categorical combinators”. In: *Information and Control* 69.1 (1986), pp. 188–254. ISSN: 0019-9958. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/S0019-9958(86)80047-X. URL: https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S001999588680047X.

[5] *Intuitionistic type theory*. Vol. 9.

[6] Maxwell Herman Alexander Newman. “On theories with a combinatorial definition of” equivalence””. In: *Annals of mathematics* 43.2 (1942), pp. 223–243.

[7] Simon L. Peyton Jones. *The Implementation of Functional Programming Languages (Prentice-Hall International Series in Computer Science)*. USA: Prentice-Hall, Inc., 1987. ISBN: 013453333X.

[8] Eike Ritter. *Categorical combinators for the calculus of constructions*. Tech. rep. University of Cambridge, Computer Laboratory, 1990.